

SCENARIO WALKTHROUGH

The Exclusive & Early Access Journey

Three member journeys, one gating mechanic, three different business reasons a merchant would send the offer at all — walked screen by screen, from discovery through attribution.

Screens shown are illustrative mockups of the intended member experience.

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SECTION 01

The Question This Walkthrough Answers

Not "what does the screen look like" — "what has to be true for this to work"

This partnership makes one specific claim: **a product can be made exclusively available through Rakuten, and Rakuten can prove — not just assert — that it was the reason the sale happened.** Everything in this walkthrough exists to make that claim concrete, scenario by scenario.

What has to be true	Where it's tested in the journey
The offer has to feel like it was <i>selected for this member</i> , not a generic coupon with an "exclusive" sticker slapped on	Scenario 1 — discovery & offer detail
The member has to trust the handoff from Rakuten's site to a merchant's site enough to actually buy — and the product genuinely has to be unreachable any other way	Scenario 1 — redirect & merchant landing
Rakuten has to be able to show, not tell, that it gets credit for the sale	Scenario 1 — confirmation & attribution proof
The same mechanic has to answer a different, specific merchant business question depending on who's targeted	Scenarios 2 & 3 — Early Access and Lapsed Re-engagement

Exclusive Drop

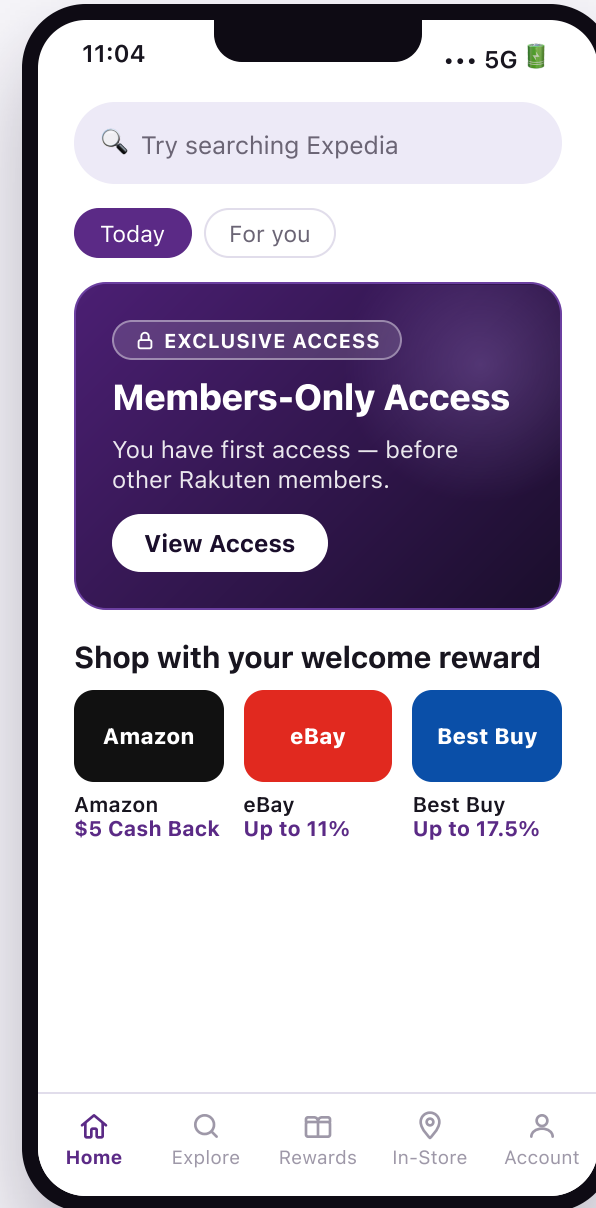
"Can you get me buyers I couldn't reach myself?"

An engaged member with category affinity — no prior relationship with the merchant required. Arc lifecycle stage: **Active**.

Scenario 1

1. Discovery

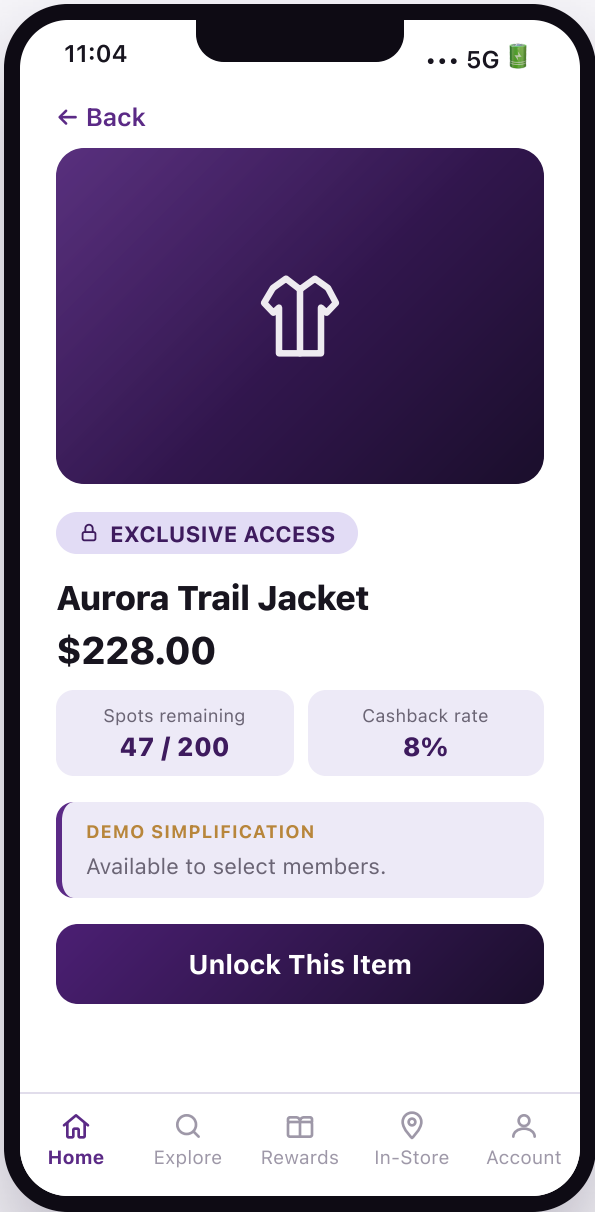
The member opens the app and sees the offer right away — we want them to feel lucky they were selected.



Scenario 1

2. Offer Detail

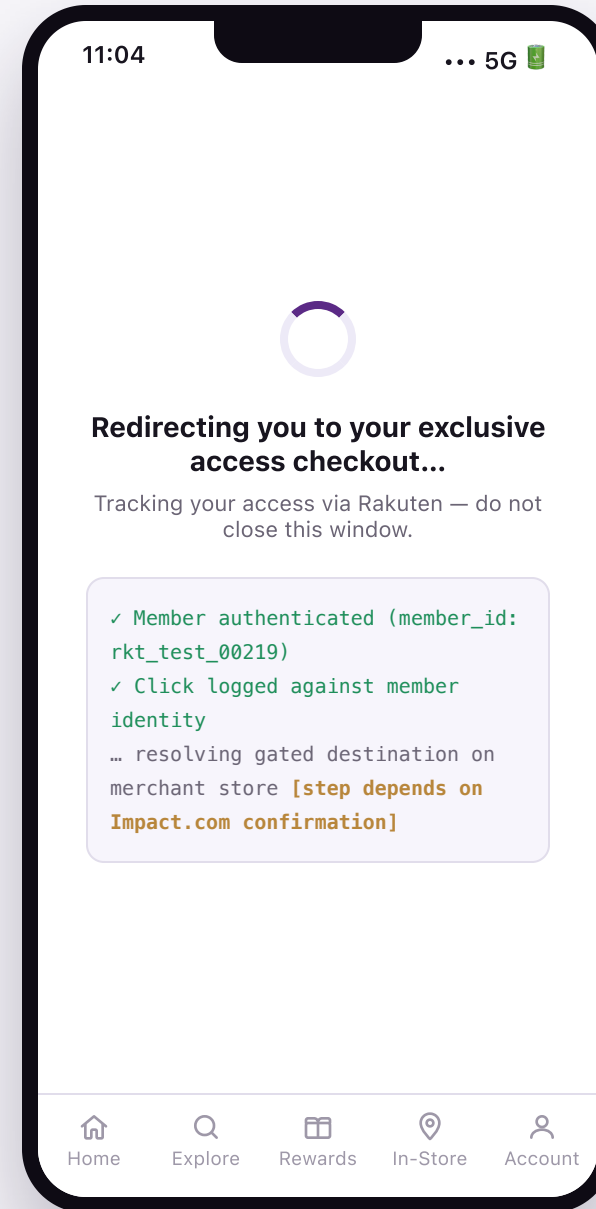
The member taps into the offer and sees what it actually is before deciding to continue.



Scenario 1

3. Redirect & Tracking

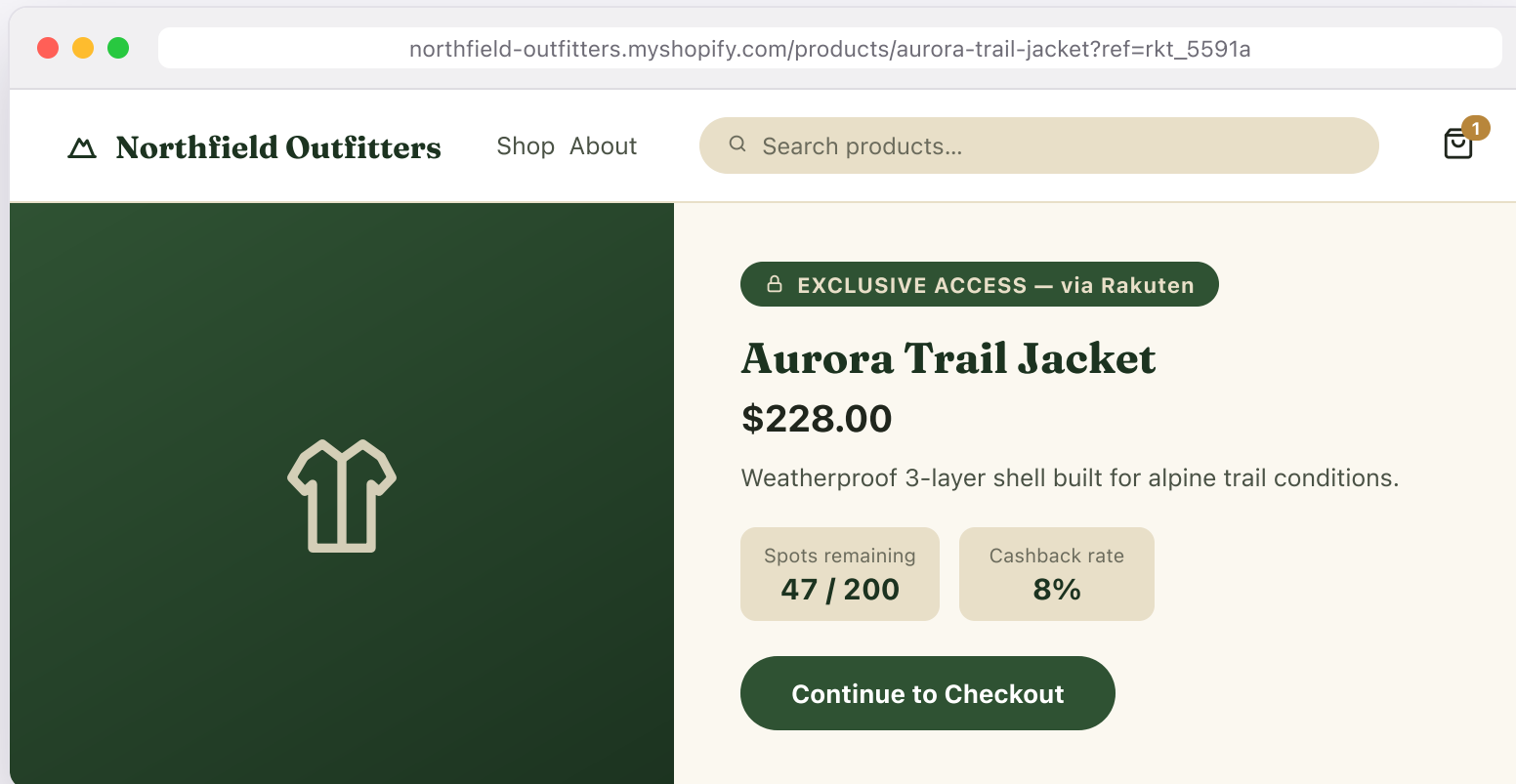
The member taps to continue and is carried from the Rakuten app to the merchant — the same kind of handoff that already happens today, just with the click tracked against their identity along the way.



Scenario 1

4. Merchant Landing

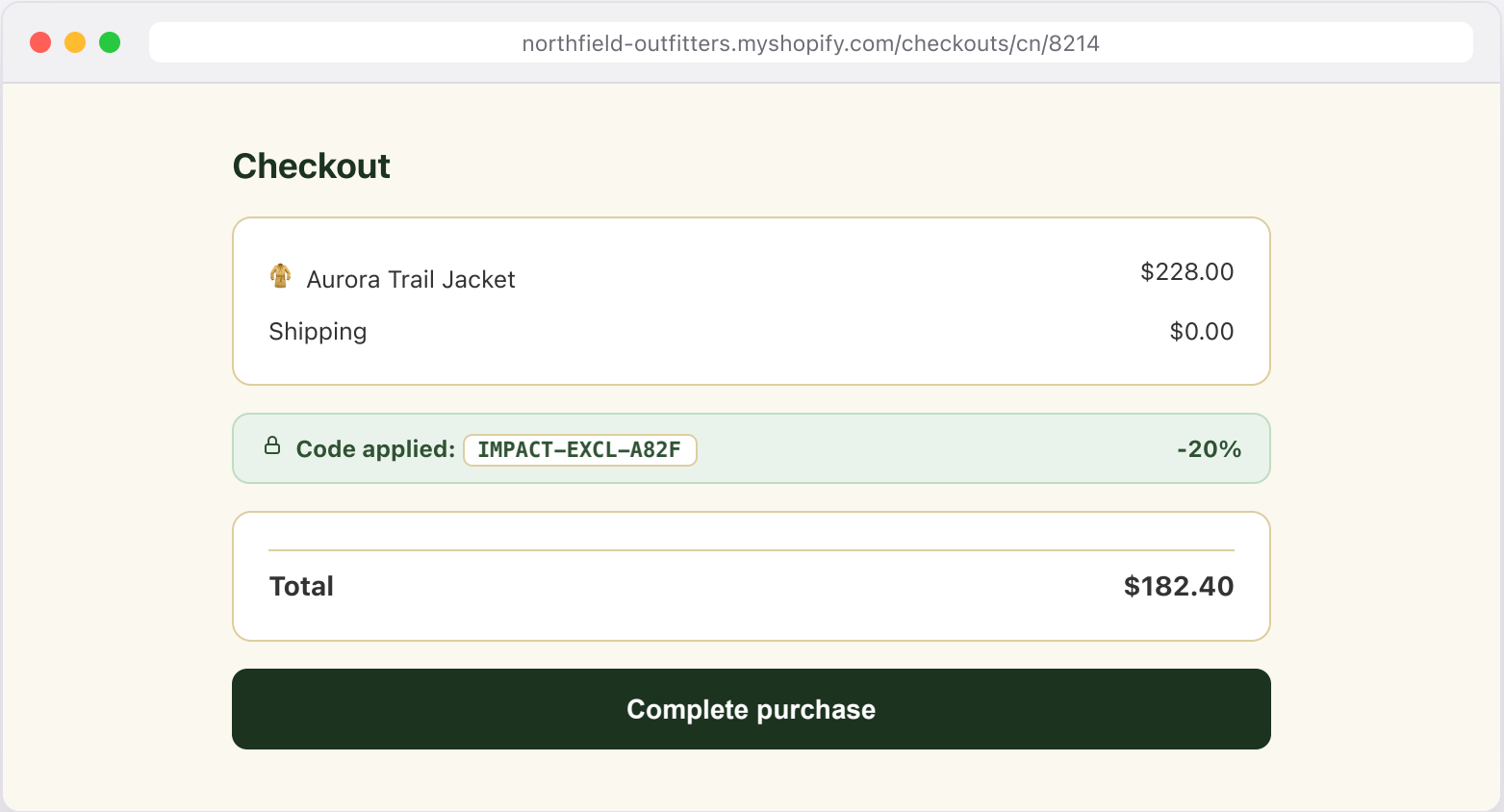
The member lands directly on the product at Northfield Outfitters — no browsing, no searching, just this page.



Scenario 1

5. Checkout

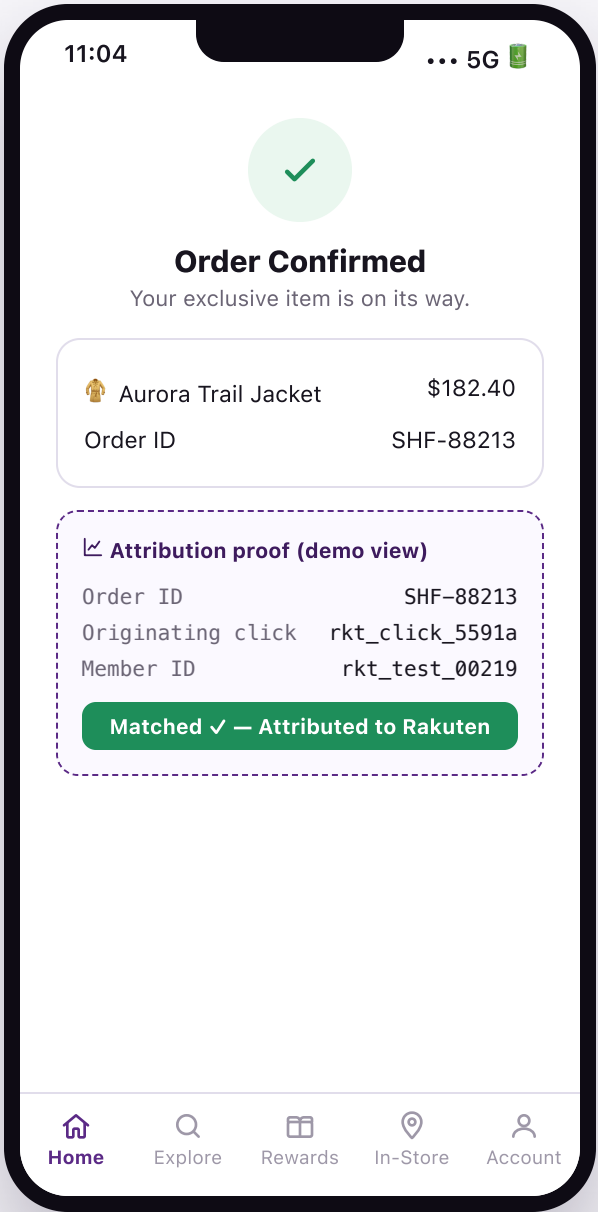
The member checks out with the discount already applied — no code to find or enter, nothing extra for them to do.



Scenario 1

6. Confirmation & Attribution Proof

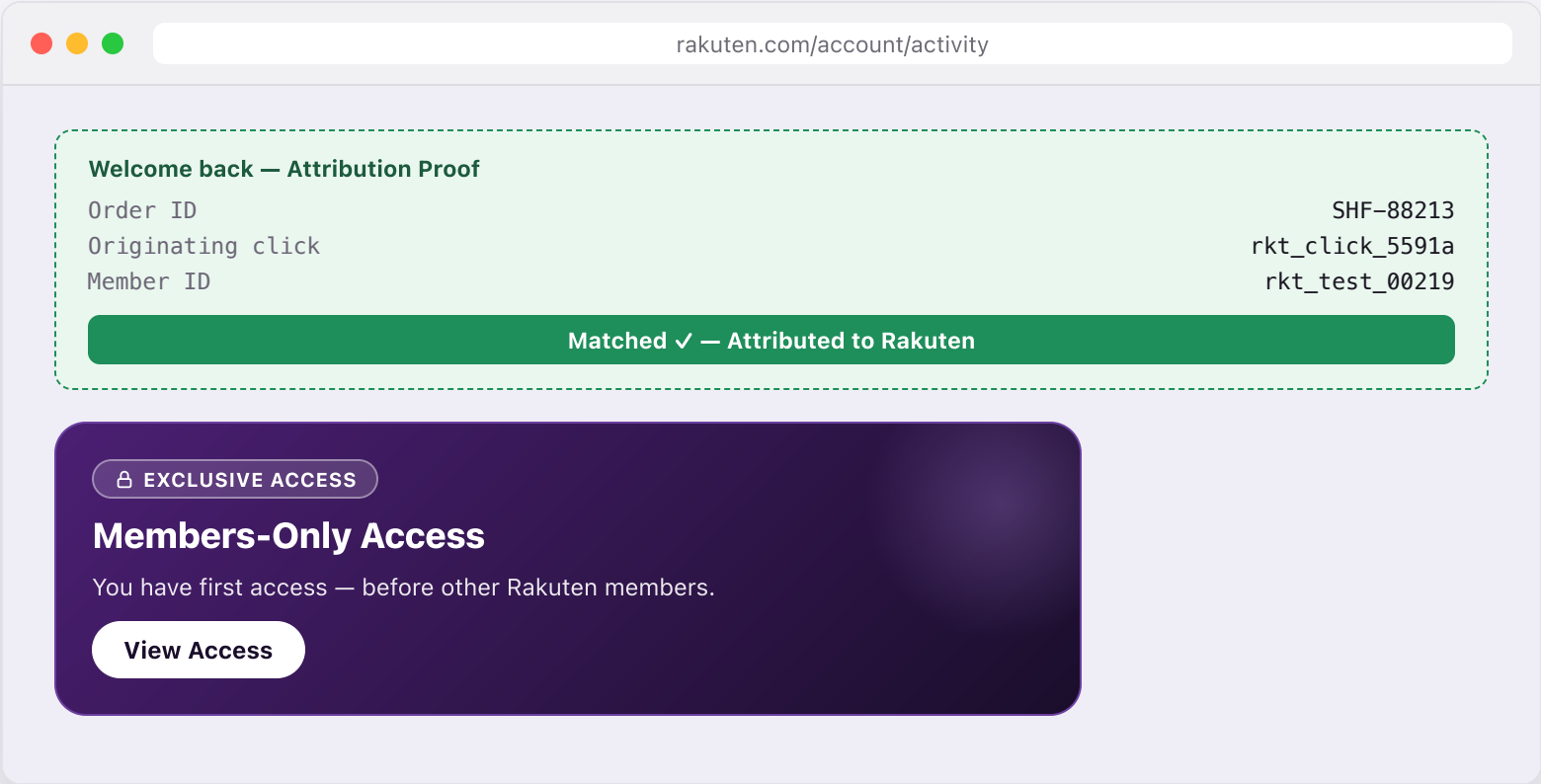
The order completes, and the purchase is matched back to the member's original click — this panel is a demo-only view so the match can be seen directly, rather than just described.



Scenario 1

7. Closing the Loop

The member returns to rakuten.com and sees a "Welcome back" panel confirming the purchase was matched — closing the loop from the original click to the completed sale.



Early Access Window

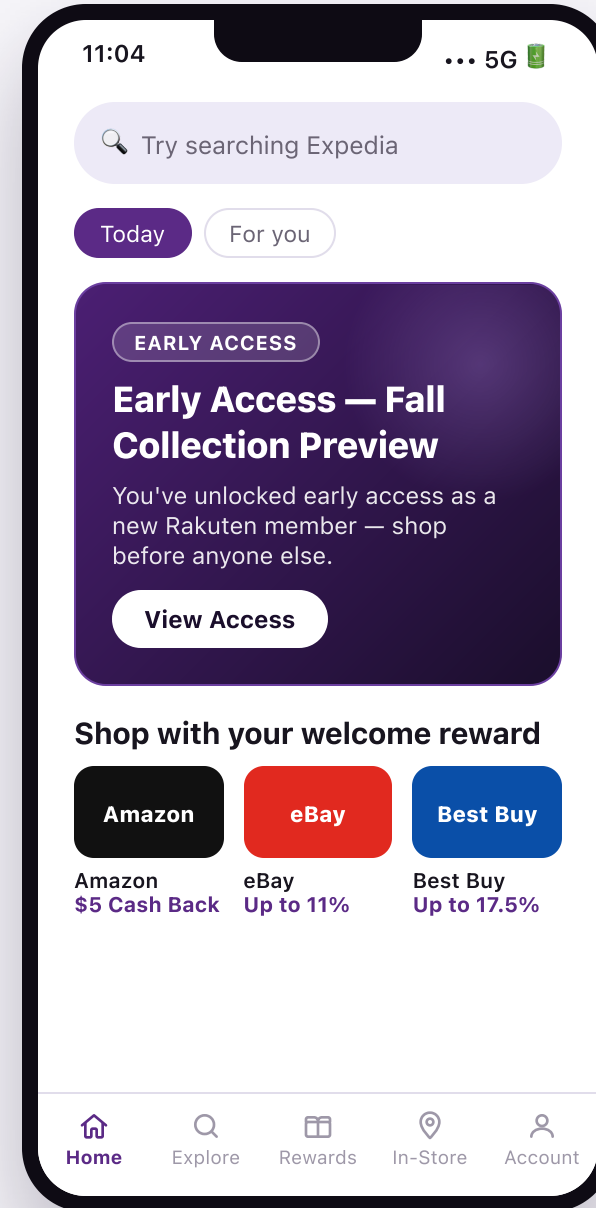
"Can you make a new customer's first experience feel special?"

A newly acquired member, given first access as a welcome moment. Arc lifecycle stage: **Acquired**. Only screens that diverge from Scenario 1 are shown below.

Scenario 2

1. Discovery

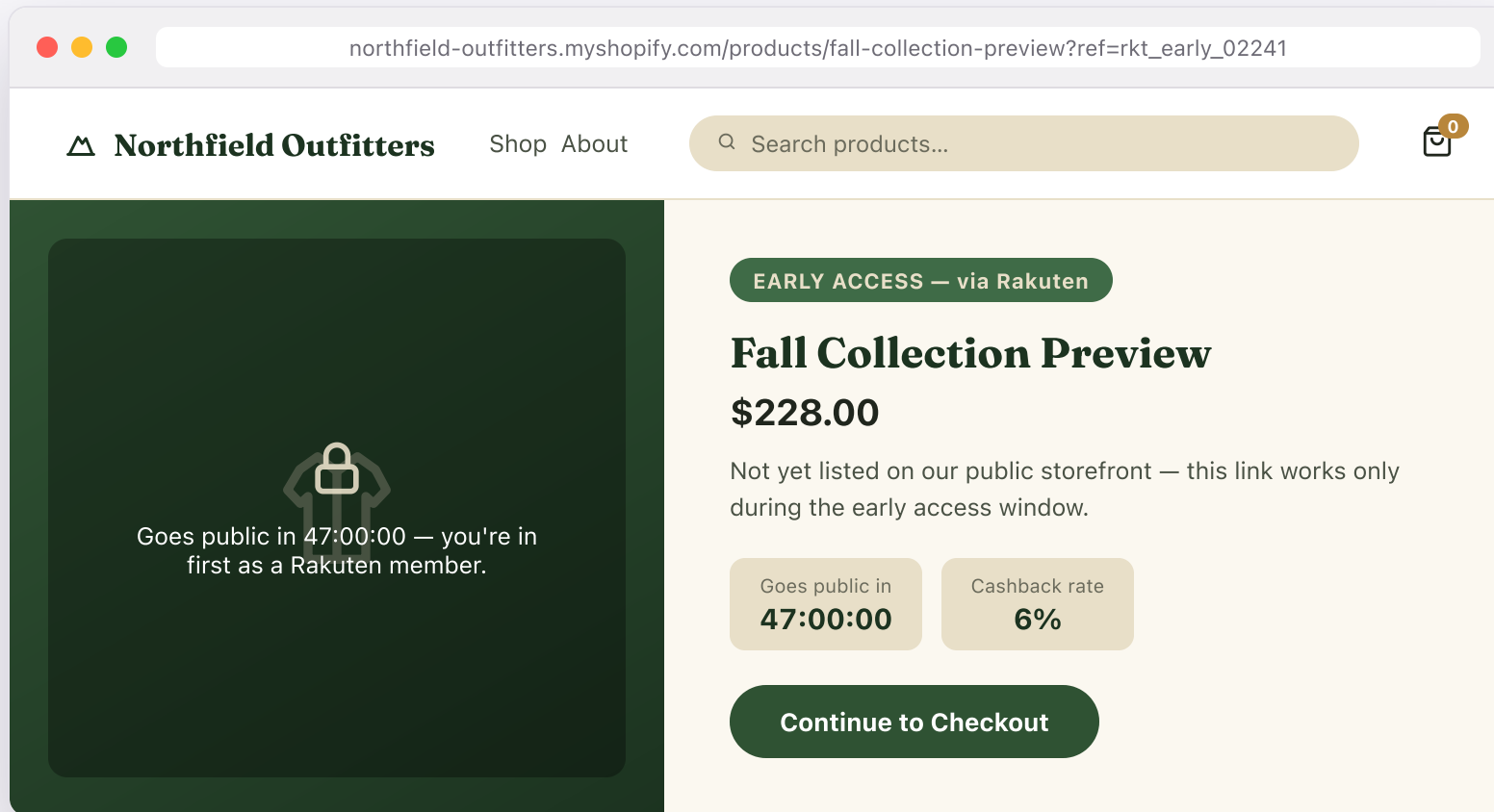
The member sees the same kind of offer as Scenario 1, but the framing shifts to a countdown until public launch — they're early, not exclusive forever.



Scenario 2

2. Merchant Landing — Before the Window Opens

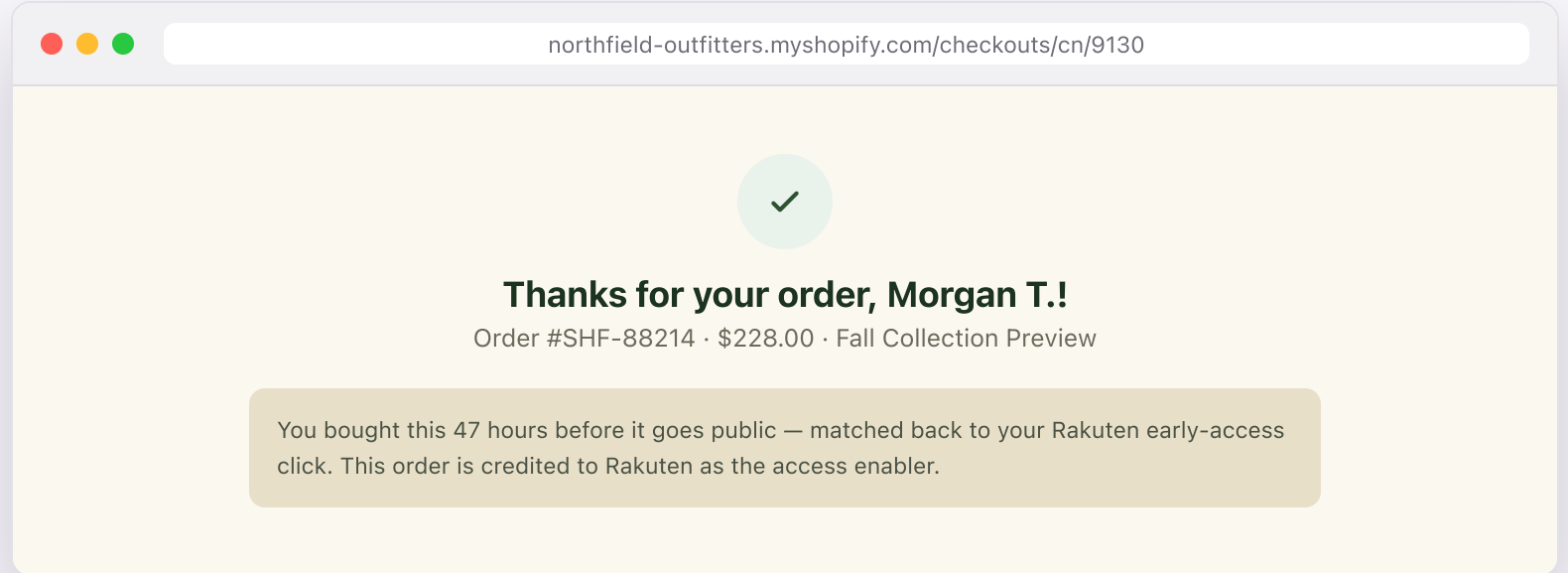
The member lands on the product early, ahead of everyone else, with a clear countdown to when it goes public.



Scenario 2

3. Checkout & Confirmation

The member checks out during the early window, before anyone else can reach the product at all.



Lapsed Re-engagement

"Can you bring back someone I've already lost?"

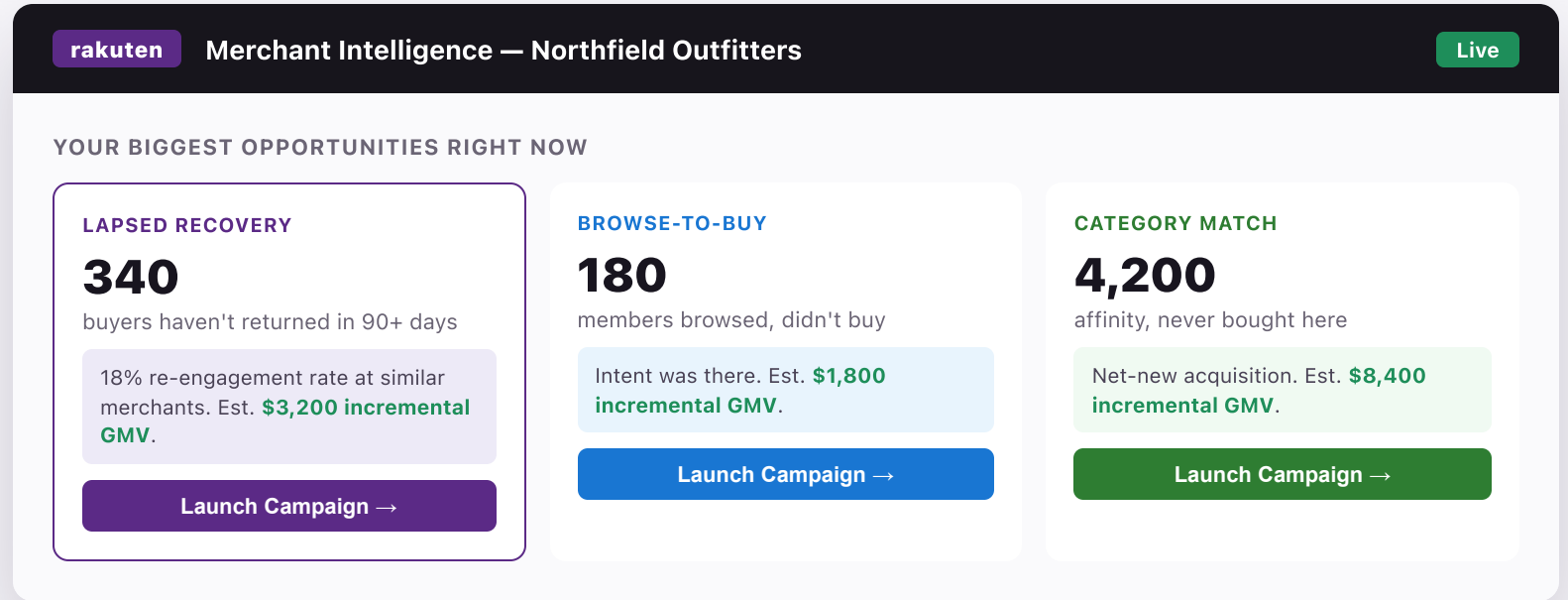
A member who bought before and went quiet 90+ days. Arc lifecycle stage: **Churned**.

There's no ambiguity about whether the sale was already going to happen.

Scenario 3

1. The Merchant's Question

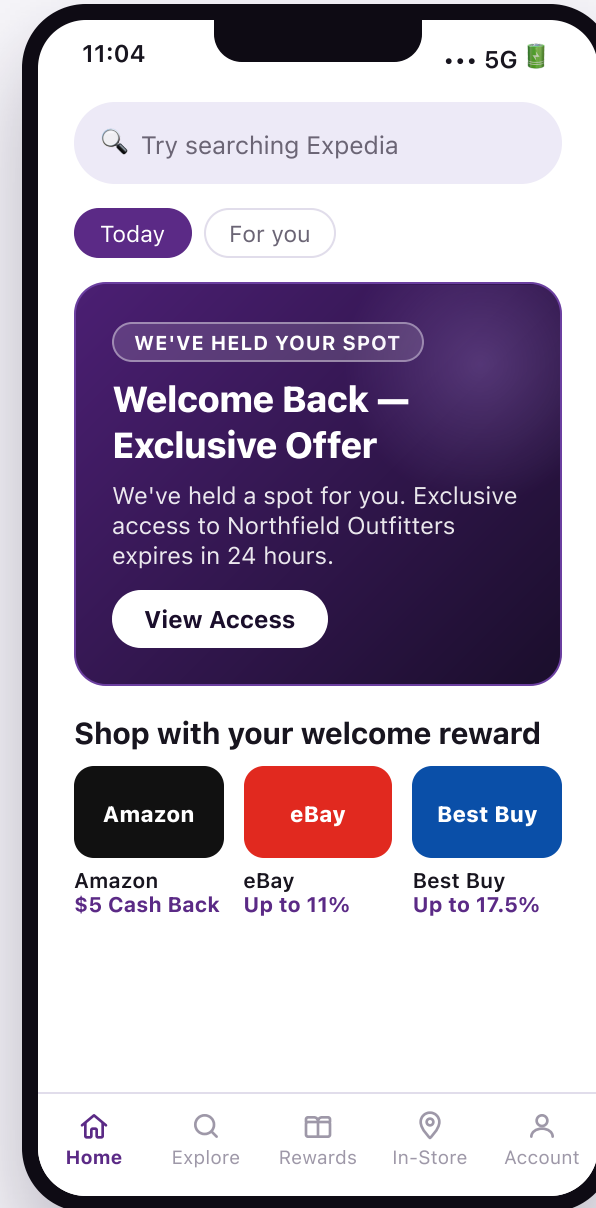
Before any member sees an offer, this is the business case that justifies sending one: Rakuten holds a signal the merchant structurally cannot generate on its own — its own lapsed buyers, ranked and quantified. This is the merchant-side payoff the rest of the scenario proves out.



Scenario 3

2. Discovery

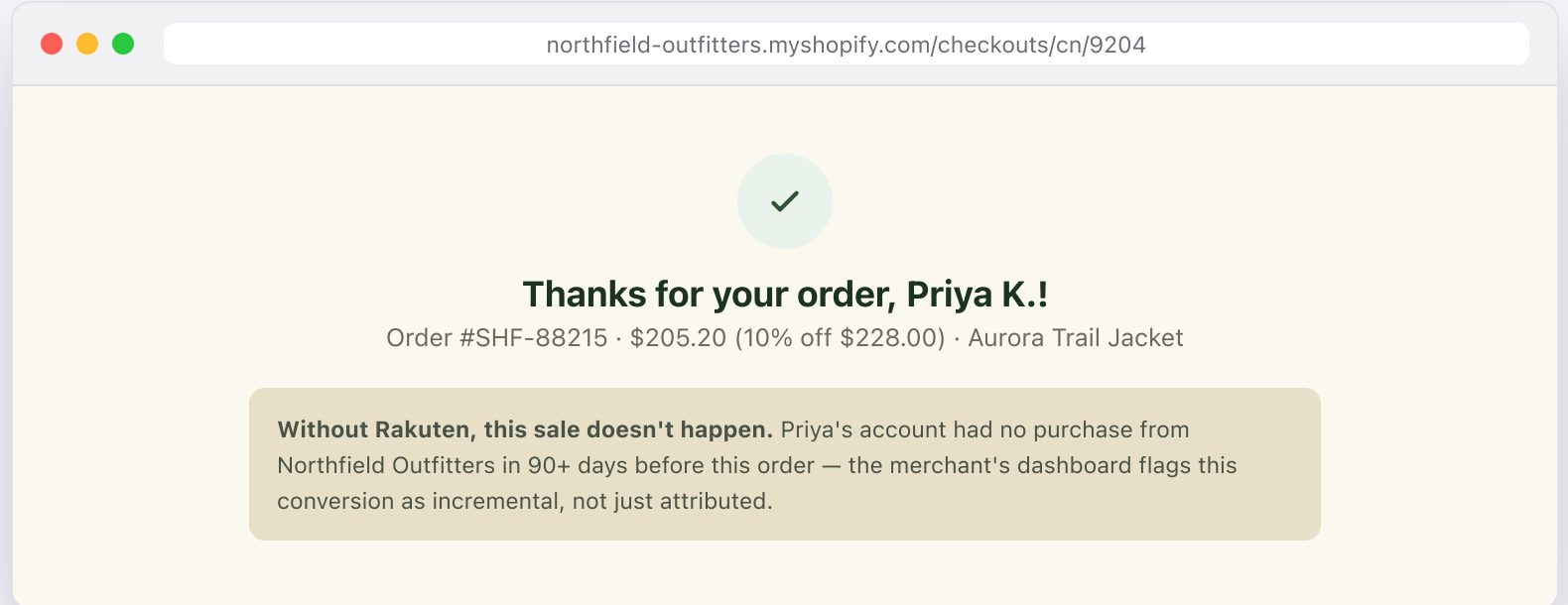
The framing shifts from "you were chosen" to "we've been waiting for you" — the elevated 10% cashback rate (vs. 8% for a first-time exclusive drop) and the 24-hour expiry both signal that Rakuten is spending real margin to win this specific member back, not sending a generic blast.



Scenario 3

3. Checkout & Confirmation

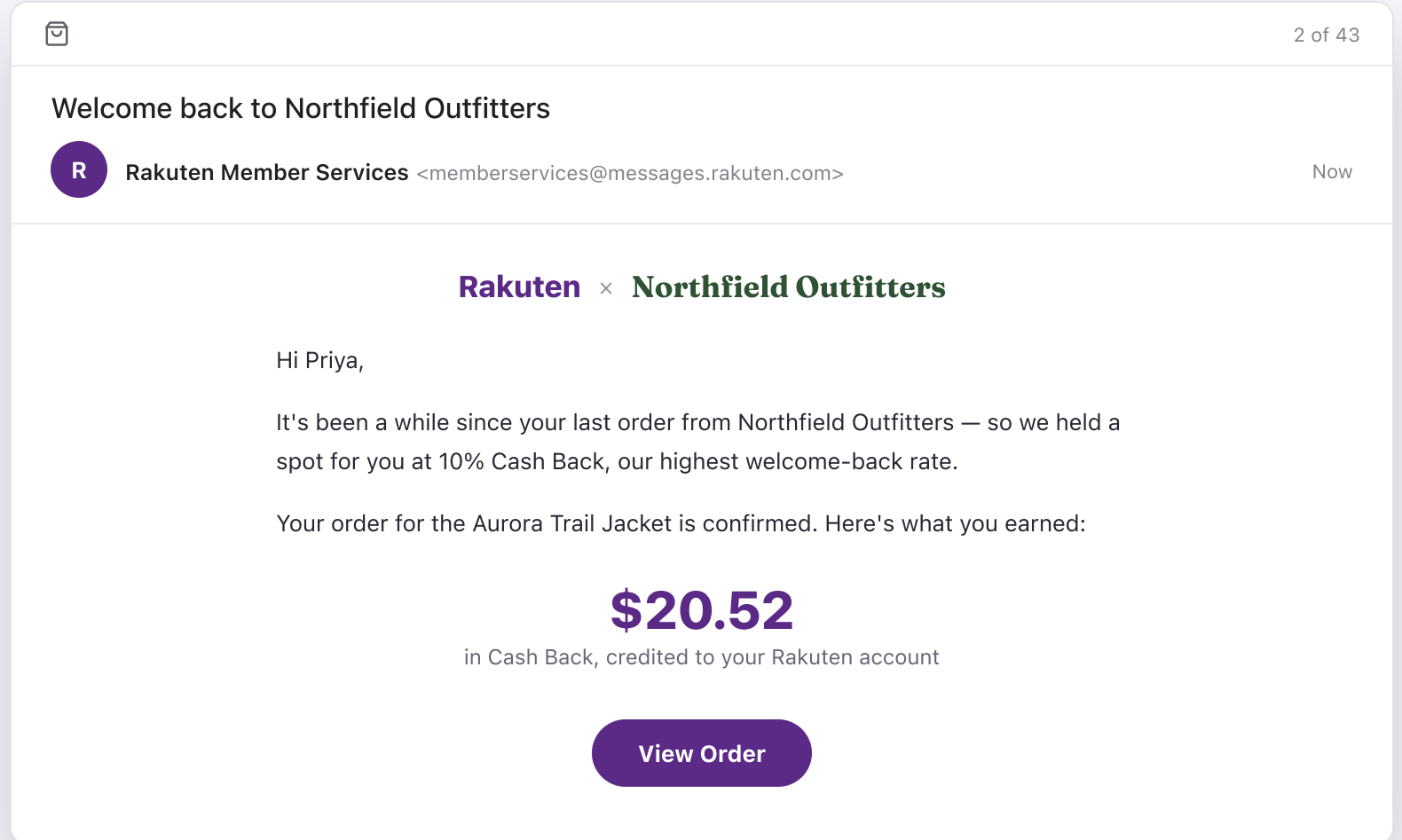
Mechanically identical to Scenario 1's checkout — the same single-use discount code pattern, just at the elevated 10% rate. The story isn't in the mechanism here; it's in who was targeted and why, which is the point of showing the merchant panel first.



Scenario 3

4. Post-Purchase Email

The re-engagement story doesn't end at checkout. A short thank-you note ties the loop off in the member's inbox.



One Flow, Three Reasons to Use It

The same mechanics, three different business justifications for why Rakuten should send this offer at all

Everything above describes the mechanical journey — offer, handoff, purchase, proof. But the same exclusivity mechanic is only valuable to a merchant if it's aimed at a member for a reason the merchant actually cares about. The same screens play out differently depending on *why* Rakuten decided this member should see the offer:

Scenario	Who's being targeted	The merchant's actual question this answers
Exclusive Drop	An engaged member with category affinity — no prior relationship required	"Can you get me buyers I couldn't reach myself?"
Early Access Window	A newly acquired member, given first access as a welcome moment	"Can you make a new customer's first experience feel special?"
Lapsed Re-engagement	A member who bought before and went quiet 90+ days	"Can you bring back someone I've already lost?" — the sale that provably wouldn't have happened otherwise

Why Lapsed Re-engagement is worth calling out specifically

There's no ambiguity about whether the sale was already going to happen. A member who bought nothing in 90+ days, then buys the day after receiving this offer, is about as clean a causal story as a merchant is ever going to get.

Section 06

Proving the Negative Case

A real shopper searching Northfield Outfitters directly — not arriving via a Rakuten link — should find nothing. Gating that's secretly still findable through normal search isn't exclusive, it's just unlinked.

